Your To-Do List Is Missing This

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 23, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/GIK66jOT35A Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter makes the case that a "stop doing" list is a missing but critical component of any goal-achievement strategy — exclusion and elimination matter as much as action.

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🚫 The Power of Exclusion 0:00

- Success is not solely about what you do — a large part of it is about what you *don't* do
  - Deliberately excluding certain behaviors and habits is itself a success strategy
- Actionable recommendation: make a dedicated "stop doing" list alongside any to-do list
  - The list should contain things you will actively cease in order to move closer to your goals

🍺 Personal Example: Quitting Alcohol and Drugs 0:00

- Brandon Carter quit recreational drugs and alcohol approximately **11 years ago**
- The first year he made **a million dollars** was that same year he quit
  - He draws a direct connection between eliminating those habits and hitting that financial milestone
- The argument is not that these things will destroy you, but that they simply do not contribute to your goals

💬 Reframing "It Won't Kill You" 0:22

- Common pushback he hears: "You can have one drink, it won't kill you"
- His counter: the standard shouldn't be survival — it should be whether something *helps* you
  - "Just because it won't kill you doesn't mean it's" (helping you) — the bar for keeping a habit should be whether it moves you forward, not merely whether it is harmless

> The key insight: stop measuring habits by whether they hurt you, and start measuring them by whether they help you.